

2019 Update of SEDAR 28: Gulf of Mexico Cobia

Landings:

- Expand observer coverage
- Increase sampling of length and age composition data from commercial landings

CPUE Indices:

- Top priority should be given to the construction of defensible abundance indices for cobia from the commercial and recreational data
- Re-examine Stevens and MacCall method to obtain subset of data

Life history:

- Implement tagging study to evaluate genetic samples to determine more precise stock boundaries as well as movement studies to identify spawning areas
- Research into cobia release mortality
- Improve data collection on the relationship of the proportion mature with age and length

Discard Data:

- Improve reporting and intercept rates
- Increase sampling for length and age composition from commercial and recreational discards

Assessment:

- Explore assumption of logistic selectivity for recreational and commercial fisheries
- Sensitivity explorations into uncertainty in landings data